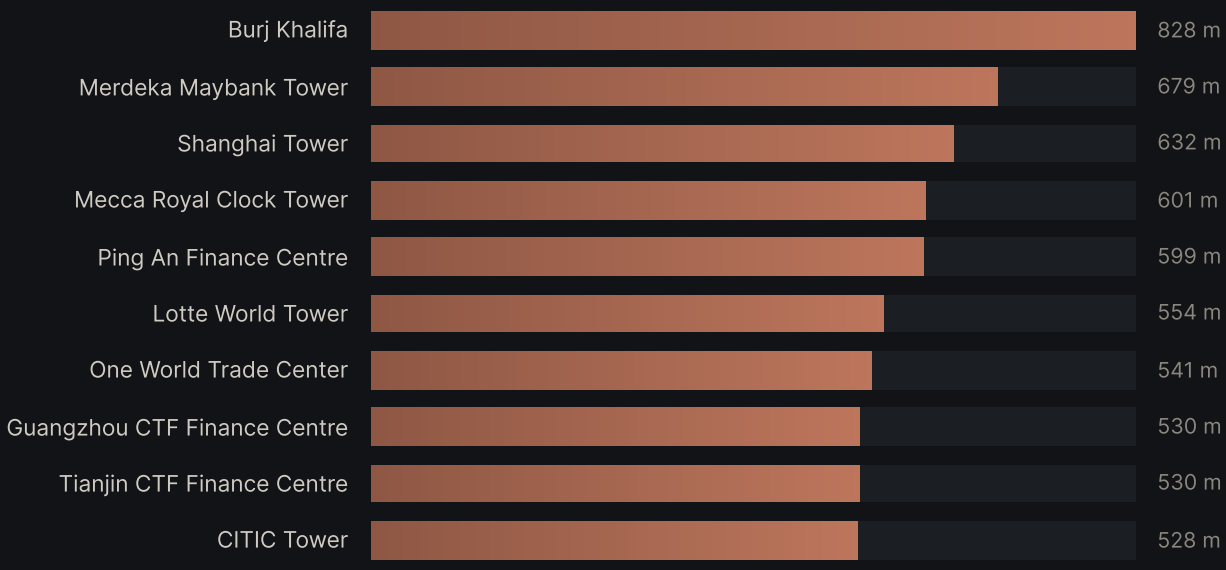
THE VERTICAL RECORD

The tallest buildings *standing today*

Eighteen structures ranked by architectural height: the measure from ground level to the top of the building itself, excluding antennas, masts and signage. Compiled from the world ranking maintained under the Council on Tall Buildings and Urban Habitat method, read 24 October 2026.

THE TOP TEN, DRAWN TO SCALE



Photography: Wikimedia Commons, under the licence noted on each frame.
Ranking source: Wikipedia, “List of tallest buildings”, page revision of 24 September 2026, retrieved 24 October 2026.



Donaldytong / CC-BY-SA-3.0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 1

Burj Khalifa

Dubai, United Arab Emirates · completed 2010

828 m

2,717 ft · 163 floors

Tallest building in the world since it topped out in 2009. Concrete-and-steel buttressed core around a Y-shaped plan.



Ahmad Ali Karim / CC0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 2

Merdeka Maybank Tower

Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia · completed 2024

679 m

2,227 ft · 118 floors

Formerly Merdeka 118. Tallest in Southeast Asia; a 118-storey glass spire rising over a historic city block.



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NO. 3

Shanghai Tower

Shanghai, China · completed 2015

632 m

2,073 ft · 128 floors

Tallest in China and East Asia. Twists 120 degrees along its height, with the world's fastest lifts.



King Eliot / CC BY-SA 3.0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 4

Mecca Royal Clock Tower

Mecca, Saudi Arabia · completed 2012

601 m

1,972 ft · 120 floors

Part of the Abraj Al-Bait complex. The largest clock faces in the world, 43 m across, visible for kilometres.



Charlie fong / CC BY-SA 4.0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 5

Ping An Finance Centre

Shenzhen, China · completed 2017

599 m

1,966 ft · 115 floors

Tallest all-office tower in the world. Its planned 660 m spire was dropped over airspace limits.



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NO. 6

Lotte World Tower

Seoul, South Korea · completed 2017

554 m

1,819 ft · 123 floors

Tallest in South Korea and in the OECD. A tapering cone with an observation deck near the crown.



Pierre Blaché / CC BY-SA 4.0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 7

One World Trade Center

New York City, United States · completed 2014

541 m

1,776 ft · 104 floors

Tallest in the Western Hemisphere. Its height to the tip is 1,776 ft, a deliberate reference to 1776.



xiquinhosilva / CC BY-SA 4.0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 8

Guangzhou CTF Finance Centre

Guangzhou, China · completed 2016

530 m

1,739 ft · 111 floors

Tied at 530 m with its Tianjin sibling; the taller of the two once the crown is counted.



BD2412 / CC BY-SA 4.0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 9

Tianjin CTF Finance Centre

Tianjin, China · completed 2019

530 m

1,739 ft · 97 floors

Tied at 530 m. The tallest building in the world with fewer than 100 floors.



N509FZ / CC BY-SA 4.0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 10

CITIC Tower

Beijing, China · completed 2018

528 m

1,731 ft · 109 floors

Known as China Zun, after the ancient zun wine vessel its silhouette copies. Tallest in Beijing.



James Tang / CC BY-SA 4.0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 11

Taipei 101

Taipei, Taiwan · completed 2004

508 m

1,667 ft · 101 floors

World's tallest from 2004 to 2009. A 660-tonne steel pendulum inside steadies it against typhoons.



Bechology / CC BY 4.0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 12

Shanghai World Financial Center

Shanghai, China · completed 2008

492 m

1,614 ft · 101 floors

The bottle-opener. Its trapezoid aperture cuts wind load and made it the tallest building with a hole.



WiNG / CC BY-SA 4.0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 13

International Commerce Centre

Hong Kong, China · completed 2010

484 m

1,588 ft · 108 floors

Tallest in Hong Kong. The sky100 deck on the 100th floor sits 393 m above Victoria Harbour.



Aangkianghai / CC BY-SA 4.0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 14

Wuhan Greenland Center

Wuhan, China · completed 2023

476 m

1,560 ft · 101 floors

A tapering, rounded-triangle tower beside the Yangtze; the tallest in Hubei province.



Percival Kestreltail / CC BY-SA 3.0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 15

Central Park Tower

New York City, United States · completed 2021

472 m

1,550 ft · 98 floors

Tallest residential building on earth. Cantilevered upper floors buy uninterrupted park views.



Andrey Korzun / CC BY-SA 4.0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 16

Lakhta Center

Saint Petersburg, Russia · completed 2019

462 m

1,516 ft · 87 floors

Tallest in Europe and the northernmost skyscraper in the world. Five twisted wings around a core.



Toanvungtau / CC BY-SA 4.0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 17

Landmark 81

Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam · completed 2018

461 m

1,513 ft · 81 floors

Tallest in Vietnam. A bundle of square tubes that step back as the tower climbs.



DvTor8303 / CC0 / Wikimedia Commons

NO. 18

International Land-Sea Center

Chongqing, China · completed 2024

458 m

1,503 ft · 98 floors

Tallest in Chongqing; a four-sided shaft that slices away as it rises.

Heights are to architectural top, the measure used for world rankings; antennas and masts are excluded, which is why some towers circulate at taller publicity figures. Ranking read 24 October 2026.

JARVIS · 24 October 2026